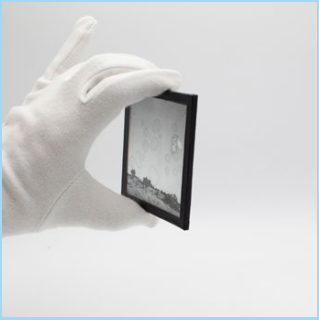
IKOS: Installationer

Decolonizing photographic archives:

an arts-based research approach

Theopisti Stylianou-Lambert



LINKÖPINGS UNIVERSITET

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Introduction

Almost 100 years ago, in October 1928, Virginia Woolf was invited to give a lecture at two women's Cambridge student societies about women and fiction. In preparation for her speech, Woolf visited the Round Reading Room of the British Museum. The impressive Reading Room opened in 1857 and could accommodate 302 readers at 38 tables all radiating from a central catalogue desk (Hillier, 2018). Readers needed to apply in advance and wait to receive permission to visit the library.

In her book "A Room of One's Own", which is based on her two lectures, Woolf (1929) writes:

> ...an answer was only to be had by consulting the learned and the unprejudiced, who have removed themselves above the strife of tongue and the confusion of body and issued the result of their reasoning and research in books which are to be found in the British Museum (p.23).

She felt that she was in the right place to find answers to her questions. Where else if not in this massive storeroom of knowledge and wisdom? She recalls: "The swing-doors swung open; and there one stood under the vast dome, as if one were a thought in the huge bald forehead which is so splendidly encircled by a band of famous names" (Woolf, 1929, p.24). We can imagine her standing under the library's dome, walking silently on the floor covered with special material to reduce noise, touching the black leather padded reading tables, and overall being impressed with the building's scale and volume of books.

Unfortunately, after a morning's work, Woolf walks out of the British Museum into the busy London streets, not with newly found knowledge, but disappointed, perplexed and with more questions than ever. Most books about women were written by men and provided authoritative but questionable and contradictory information. She arrives at the conclusion that the conditions under patriarchal societies rendered women and their histories anonymous and invisible. What the British Museum's Library had to offer at the time was the viewpoint of male authors who were unable to speak on behalf of women. She sincerely asks: "If truth is not to be found on the shelves of the British Museum, where, I ask myself, picking up a notebook and a pencil, is truth?" (Woolf, 1928, p.23).

Nearly a century after Woolf's experience – and despite the significant strides made in postcolonial and

feminist theory – it seems that I am still navigating a circumstance that closely mirrors hers. In my case, I was searching in publications produced during the colonial period in Cyprus (1878 – 1960) to understand archaeological work and the role of local workers during this period. My search in these publications was a disappointment to say the least. Like Woolf who could not find answers about women and fiction in books written by men, I could not find answers about local workers in books and journal publications written by foreign explorers and archaeologists who were mostly western, white, and male.

During the colonial period, most Cypriot workers at excavation sites, and especially women, did not know how to write, did not keep diaries, and obviously did not publish their findings and experiences. As a result, their stories cannot be found in publications of the time or in institutional archives today. The written records that inform our understandings of history were written by the privileged; those with education, wealth, or power. Furthermore, even though locals are mentioned in unpublished correspondence and appear in photographs, they were edited out from published reports (Given, 2025).

The advances in feminist and decolonial studies have fundamentally transformed how we interpret historical records preserved in institutions like libraries, museums, and archives. We now recognise that absences and misrepresentations are not anomalies

but inherent features of these records. However, these historical records are all we have.

So, I gave up and took the liberty of paraphrasing Woolf's question and asked myself: If truth is not to be found in colonial-era publications related to Cypriot archaeology, where, I ask myself, picking up a camera and a notebook, is truth? If the past cannot be fully understood through written records, can photography perhaps help? What if colonial-era photographic archives in collecting institutions could reveal local workers? How can I, an artist/researcher whose main medium is photography, contribute to bringing to the surface the stories and experiences of local workers?

Archaeology-related photographic archives

But before we proceed any further, we must ask a crucial question: Are photographic archives more reliable than written records?

Photography was born at about the same time as professional archaeology and what united archaeology and photography in the second half of the 19th century was the search for true representation, accuracy, and the detailed collection of information (Hamilakis and Ifantidis, 2015). Photography was perceived by archaeologists as a mechanical tool for "seeing" that could faithfully and accurately represent reality and therefore was used as a tool for recording excavation sites and objects along with drawings, maps, and measurements. Photography in archaeology has since been used to record, document, and illustrate. As such, it plays a significant role in the production of archaeological knowledge. But we also know that photography is a highly selective tool and has been connected from the very beginning with issues of power, surveillance, and control (Tagg, 1999). Photography has never been innocent or value-free and this is important to keep in mind. Photography is a tool in the hands of people with specific perceptions, assumptions, and goals.

In 2014 I remember attending a Royal Anthropological Institute conference that took place at the British Museum. One of the researchers and museum professionals who significantly influenced my own work – the visual and historical anthropologist Elisabeth Edwards – delivered a keynote lecture titled "Anthropology and Photography: a long history of knowledge and affect" (Edwards, 2014). I remember listening to her lecture and scribbling in my notebook, over and over again, the word "standpoint". Edwards explained that we must imagine that anthropologists were photographing indigenous people from their own standpoint – literally and figuratively speaking. Literally speaking because photographs indicate the anthropologists' own physical positions on the ground; where they actually stood and where they chose to point their cameras. And figuratively speaking, because their mental standpoint, a combination of their beliefs and attitudes at the time, influences what and how something or someone was being photographed. As a result, images can be saturated with subjective values and ideologies that are not immediately apparent. For this reason, when we are looking at a photograph in an archive, we must forget for a moment what the photograph *represents* and try instead to imagine the *photographic process* as it must have unfolded. We must ask questions such as: What were the circumstances of photographing something or someone? What did the photographer choose to include in the photographic

frame? Why? What has been omitted? What has been staged?

Let's take as an example one of the most famous archaeological images ever made and used widely in media coverage. The photograph showing the archaeologist Howard Carter crouched before the open shrine doors of the burial chamber of Tutankhamun's tomb taken by the expedition's photographer Harry Burton on January 3rd 1924, around the same time Virginia Woolf was preparing her speech. The image – and Burton's photographic collection – is digitized and available online at the Griffin Institute's website (The Griffin Institute, no date, image number PO626). Tutankhamun's excavation was one of the first to systematically use photography for documentation and Burton's photographs were published and republished for years in magazines and newspapers for the eyes of eager audiences (Bohner, 2011). In her book "Photographing Tutankhamun", Christina Riggs (2019) discusses this particular photograph and explains that it was staged to excite the public imagination. The archaeologist is presented as being alone with a large spotlight that we assume throws light for the very first time on the treasures of the boy king. Viewers cannot see what the archaeologist sees. What they are supposed to see is the glorious moment of discovery. But viewers would probably be disappointed if they knew that what Carter actually saw in this picture was not treasures, but another set of doors.

What is absent from the photograph of discovery are the workers who worked for months to get to this point, who cracked the door open and who probably arranged for the lighting for this photograph. Absent is also the photographic process where tripods are installed, reflectors are being held, directions are given, and multiple exposures are taken. But this single photograph works so well as a symbol of the archaeological imagination – of discovery, persistence, and achievement – that was used widely in the press and publications. This is an example of a *dominant image* from a collection of many other images. Indeed, the archive contains images of local Egyptians working in the burial chambers, yet such photographs were largely omitted from the publications of the time.

To return to my original question, are photographic archives more reliable than written records? The simple answer is *no*. Photographic archives reflect the standpoint of the archaeologist/photographer and they are selective and biased representations of reality. However, because of the mechanical reproduction of photography, more is included in the photographic frame, such as objects and people that might not have been considered important at the time, things of passing interest, or even accidents. Therefore, it is possible to discover and re-activate some of these dormant archival images today.

Cypriot workers in colonial-era photographic archives

Much like the Tutankhamun expedition, colonial excavations in Cyprus had their main protagonists such as the Italian Luigi Palma Di Cesnola, British Herbert Kitchener, German Max Ohnefalsch-Richter, and British Sir John Linton Myres. And of course, Swedish Alfred Westholm, Erik Sjöqvist, and Einar Gjerstad, along with the expedition's photographer John Lindros. The Cyprus Swedish Expedition took place between 1927 and 1931 and is considered one of the most important expeditions of the 20th century in Cyprus. These foreign excavators used photography to record excavation work, findings, archaeological processes, and to publish their findings. Photography served for documentation, proof of discovery, ownership, and even to advertise antiquities for sale (Stylianou-Lambert, Heraclidou and Lewis, 2024). The photographic archives of these archaeologists – much like Cypriot antiquities – can be found in prestigious museums and universities abroad. But I was not interested in the photographs these archaeologists have already published or their own portraits with antiquities. I was interested in finding obscure photographs of local workers.

In 2022, Antigone Heraclidou, Joanna Lewis and I were fortunate enough to receive a grant by the Hellenic Observatory of the London School of Economics, UK to allow us to examine colonial photographic archives related to Cypriot archaeology maintained by museums in Cyprus and the UK and to make policy suggestions on how these archives could be decolonialized. Our research and funding brought us to four institutions that care for archaeology-related photographic archives produced during the colonial era in Cyprus: the British Museum, the Ashmolean Museum, the Institute of Archaeology at Oxford University, and the Bank of Cyprus Cultural Foundation.

The photographic archives we examined were created by foreign, Western archaeologists and explorers who were in search of knowledge, power, or profit. As expected, their photographic records were influenced by their own standpoints and attitudes towards locals and the land, and reflect colonial viewpoints. We found out that in terms of representation, the photographic material tends to present archaeological sites as sites of knowledge, and objects as evidence of finds. In the few cases locals appear in the photographs, they tend to be working in groups or posing for group portraits. Considered a mindless workforce, they almost always remain unnamed. They are the "hands" of archaeology. On the other hand, Western excavators are photographed alone, overseeing work, giving the appearance of being

the “minds” and “eyes” of archaeology (Stylianou-Lambert, Heraclidou and Lewis, 2024). Recent studies in the Middle East confirm these findings by indicating that indigenous people are more often than not absent or misrepresented in photographic archives (Emmott, 2022; Riggs, 2019; Quirke, 2010). When these individuals do appear in photographs, their presence typically serves to indicate scale, document the progress of the excavation, or show the number of labourers employed.

Regardless of the way local workers were represented in these colonial-era photographic archives, I was still touched by images that showed workers hard at work, sometimes staring directly at the camera acknowledging the photographer; the women who sometimes did most of the work because they were paid less than men; workers touching objects or posing with objects to show scale; and the local foremen who were the connecting link between the workers and the archaeologists and arguably had more influence than was ever acknowledged. I was interested in the shadows, the ghosts, and the hands of archaeology.

Decolonizing or reframing photographic archives through arts-based research

Having this in mind, is it possible to decolonize photographic archives, and if yes, how? After considering our findings and the current literature on decolonization, museums, and archives, we suggested the following seven strategies for *reframing* photographic archives in museums and other collecting institutions: (a) acknowledge that a photographic archive is a product of its time; (b) review and update terminology; (c) research and enrich photographic archives; (d) digitise and widen access; (e) work with communities; (f) reveal hidden stories; and (g) work with artists. To expand on these strategies and facilitate wider distribution, we put together a policy brief, which was send to all museums with Cypriot archives (Stylianou-Lambert and Heraclidou, 2024).

But it also became painfully clear to me – even as I was working on suggestions for decolonizing archives for museum professionals – that while the attempt to decolonize museums may be noble and necessary, it may also be only scratching the surface. For example, how do you decolonize large, national museums whose establishment, power structures, and practices are based on colonialism? Can you really decolonize the British Museum – a direct result of colonialization

and a colonial product itself? Or do we need to build from scratch completely different institutions whose processes and practices are not based on 19th century colonial viewpoints and understandings? Increasingly, I felt that "decolonizing" might be the wrong word to use in my work. I felt that – especially for photographic archives – the word "reframing" might be more appropriate, and this is the word we eventually used in our policy suggestions. While my work still falls under the umbrella of decolonial practices, the word reframing better reflects my own research and artistic practice. As an artist/researcher, I am trying to reframe the colonial-era archives I encounter by shifting my attention on the unnamed, indigenous workforce with the help of arts-based research.

My integration of artistic and research practices began as an intuitive, organic process, rather than a deliberate methodological decision. But ultimately, arts-based research provided a way to navigate my dilemma of how to engage with colonial-era photographic archives, especially given my lack of power to dismantle the enduring structures of colonial authority embedded within them. According to Seppälä, Sarantou, and Miettinen (2021), "we have a responsibility as researchers to contribute towards the aim of decolonizing academic research through our own active engagement, that is, by decolonizing our research practices and 'knowledge-practices'" (p.6). Arts-based research allowed me to do just that – to

decolonize, not the archives themselves, but my own research methods so that they became more inclusive, reflective, and critical. It allowed me to have an open mind, co-create with others, deal with insecurity and chaos, and view archival ecosystems in a more holistic manner.

What follows is the introduction of three of my arts-based research projects that focus on throwing light on the unnamed and unacknowledged Cypriot local workers at archaeological excavations.

Project 1: "Talking Hands"

The first project is titled “Talking Hands” (2022-2024) and aimed to give voice to the “hands” of archaeology. This was achieved by recording the experiences and stories of residents of Episkopi village who were involved for decades as workers in archaeological excavations at the nearby Kourion site; one of Cyprus’ most important city-kingdoms and urban centres in antiquity.

For this project, I collaborated with Elisavet Stefani an archaeologist who was born and raised in Episkopi, Cyprus; Polina Nikolaou, a specialist in the history of archaeology of Cyprus; and Michael Given, an archaeologist and senior lecturer at the University of Glasgow who has worked for many years at the archaeological site of Kourion. Our focus was on people, not objects, on omitted stories, not official narratives or biographies of foreign archaeologists. In 2022 and 2023, we talked to eleven people between the ages of 65 and 87, who were recruited through word of mouth, and whose lives were connected to archaeological work: Eleni Christou, Socrates Savva, Thessalia (Sally) Onoufriou Kyriakou, Maroulla Triantafilidou, Antonis Polycarpou, Maria Alexandrou, Demosthenis Theodorou, Katina Tyllirou, Chrystalla Evangelou, Anna Konstantinou, and Irene Kontou.

Most of our participants worked at archaeological excavations at Kourion as seasonal workers, supporting staff at various expeditions, or as guards or specialized technicians.

Most interviews took place in a relaxed and informal environment at the garden of the Local Archaeological Museum of Kourion, which is located at the heart of Episkopi village. Along with the interviews, I took photographs of the space and portraits of the participants. Additionally, to get a glimpse of the past, we asked participants to find and show us photographs they had at home related to archaeology. These personal photographs often served as a starting point for discussions and stories. But most importantly, they provided an "alternative" archaeology-related archive to those found in museums and other collecting institutions.

For a trained archaeologist, the land is a space of knowledge, measurement, documentation, careful excavation, and discovery. On the other hand, for most of our participants, the land is forever a living, familiar space, and a source of livelihood. The areas of Kourion and Episkopi were the playground of our participants as children, a land they are intimately familiar with, a land they have seen changing through time. While archaeological narratives usually focus on unique objects and what these objects can tell us about a distant past, our participants' narratives focus on the

archaeological process, the physical work itself, the land, and its people.

We shared these stories and photographs in a photobook titled "Talking Hands", which was published by the Department of Antiquities of Cyprus in 2024 (Stylianou-Lambert, Stefani, Nicolaou, and Given, 2024) (see Figure 1). At the same time, an exhibition of the project took place at the Local Archaeological Museum of Episkopi. The exhibition included an artistic intervention consisting of inserts in display cases of small, postcard-sized photographs. The inclusion of our participants' portraits in the exhibition cases is a powerful act that acknowledges their contributions and reintegrates them within a history they were vital in creating. After all, there is a general assumption that what is behind museum glass cases is valuable and worth preserving for the future. Furthermore, arranging the photographs next to museum objects unavoidably created new relationships and associations (see Figure 2). In summary, "Talking Hands" adopted a sociological, oral history and artistic approach to reveal what is usually omitted from archaeological records and to create a rupture in official narratives.



Figure 1. Book spread from photobook "Talking Hands" (2024). Published by the Department of Antiquities, Cyprus. © Theopisti Stylianou-Lambert, Elisavet Stefani, Polina Nikolaou, and Michael Given.



Figure 2. Installation view of "Talking Hands" at the Local Archaeological Museum of Kourion, Episkopi (2024). Photograph by Theopisti Stylianou-Lambert.

Project 2: "The Archive of Unnamed Workers"

The second project is titled “The Archive of Unnamed Workers” (2022) and was a collaboration with artist Alexia Achilleos. Achilleos’ work explores the power dynamics shaping technology and she mainly works with artificial intelligence (AI). After playing with different platforms that can produce AI-generated images, we discovered that historical power asymmetries and colonial-era narratives found in archaeological photographic archives, are *perpetuated* by current text-to-image AI tools.

For example, when we gave the text prompt “a 19th century photograph of an archaeologist in Cyprus” (in English) to DALL·E 2, the model generated images of exclusively white men wearing western clothing at a location that resembles an archaeological site, providing a gendered and racialized representation of what an archaeologist of that time looked like. On the other hand, when given the prompt “a 19th century photograph of a Cypriot archaeologist”, the model was unable to generate images that bore any resemblance to historic portrayals of the Cypriot population of the time. Instead, the model’s outputs portrayed Orientalizing depictions of a variety of non-white people, only one of them placed visually

in an archaeological context (Stylianou-Lambert and Achilleos, 2024). The algorithmic representation of "Cypriots", in other words, is generated through an Orientalizing Western gaze.

"The Archive of Unnamed Workers" includes 40 fictional portraits of Cypriot workers that were created using Generative Adversarial Network (GAN) machine learning technology. In the new portraits, most workers appear to be smiling and looking at an imaginary "camera" (see Figure 3). This is because we trained the system with images from staged archaeological group photographs of workers we found in photographic archives. Creating believable images of Cypriot people involved in archaeological excavations is something that AI-generated tools at the time were unable to do. As we have seen, they produced either images of white, Western men, or exoticized, non-Western people who do not look Cypriot. We had to train an AI model to be able to produce images of Cypriot workers that would be believable as such.

Another important aspect of the work is its materiality. We felt that we needed to "return" the AI-generated images into a materiality appropriate for a missing archive. For this reason, we decided to transfer the images to 35mm glass photographic slides, a technology widely used in the mid-20th century that is almost obsolete today.



Figure 3. "The Archive of Unnamed Workers" (2022). Medium: 40, 35mm slides. The artwork includes AI-generated images. © Theopisti Stylianou-Lambert and Alexia Achilleos.

The completed work was presented for the first time in an exhibition titled "In the Sea of the Setting Sun: Contemporary Photographic Practices and the Archive" (November 2022 – April 2023) that took place at the State Gallery of Contemporary Art, in Nicosia, Cyprus. Subsequently, it was on display at the Jeu de Paume in Paris, France, as part of the exhibition "The world through AI" (April – September 2025). In both spaces, a large white cube was constructed to house the projection. Viewing the work was only possible through pinholes punched at various heights into the white cube (see Figure 4). The cube created a feeling of a closed, inaccessible space – much like many photographic archives found in museums – that visitors had to

physically approach and look at through the holes. In general, “The Archive of Unnamed Workers” aimed to expose power structures and patterns of exclusion that are perpetuated by AI technology today.

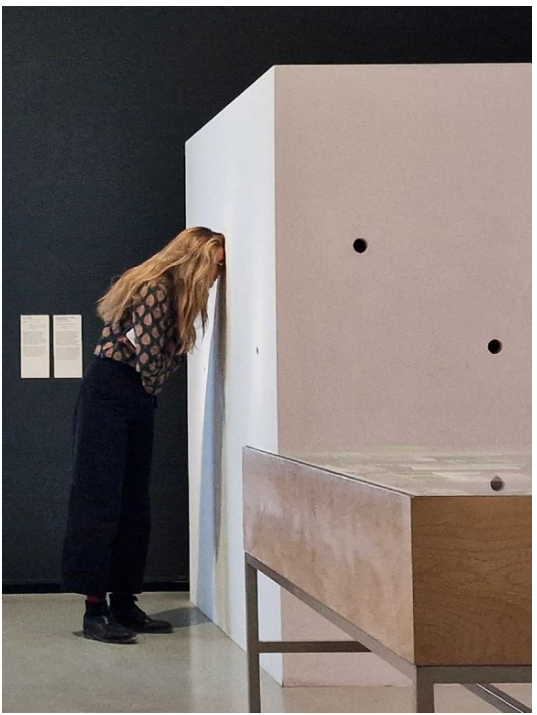


Figure 4. Exhibition view from the “The World through AI” at Jeu de Paume in Paris, France (11 April - 21 September 2025). Curated by Antonio Somaini, Ada Ackerman, Alexandre Gefen and Pia Viewing. Photograph by Theopisti Stylianou-Lambert.

Project 3: "The Archive of Grigoris Antoniou"

The third project is titled “The Archive of Grigoris Antoniou” (2024) and it was the continuation of our work with Alexia Achilleos. The work was commissioned by the Hasselblad Foundation in Gothenburg for the exhibition “Bugs and Metamorphosis” (February – May 2025) and later travelled to the Kunsthal Aarhus in Denmark (June – December 2025).

Grigoris Antoniou (c. 1850s–1940) was a Cypriot foreman who is perhaps the most underrepresented figure of Cypriot and Middle Eastern archaeology at the turn of the 20th century. Antoniou was always sought after because he was extremely skilful in finding and removing antiquities, as well as in organizing and guiding workers. He was indispensable to many archaeologists who excavated in Cyprus (Hogarth, Myres, Munro, and Tubbs, to name a few), as well as to the famous Arthur Evans in Knossos, Crete, and to Laurence of Arabia in Turkey. Identifying Antoniou in photographic archives proved challenging until, we discovered a lantern slide at Oxford University’s Institute of Archaeology bearing a label that listed the individuals pictured. One of them was identified as Grigoris Antoniou. Now that we had a name, we

wondered: What would Grigoris Antoniou have photographed if he had had a camera? And thus, we set out to speculate on the "missing" archive of Grigoris Antoniou.

With the help of Thomas Kiely (A.G. Leventis Curator for Ancient Cyprus, British Museum) and Helia Zakeri (research assistant at CYENS Centre of Excellence) we identified key moments in Antoniou's biography, and we used AI technology to recreate possible photographs that Antoniou might have taken. In other words, we attempted to imagine Antoniou's own *standpoint* – physically and metaphorically speaking. The 40 selected images that became part of the work include a combination of Cypriot landscapes, archaeological sites, objects, and everyday scenes. Furthermore, our search resulted in more real archival photographs of Antoniou which were reframed and used as part of this fictional archive. The final images include mostly AI-generated visuals and eight real archival photographs, thus blurring the line between fiction and reality.

As in the previous project, it was important for us to return the fictional archive into a materiality appropriate to the turn of the 20th century, when Antoniou lived and worked. We chose ambrotypes in the form of lantern slides – much like the lantern slide that inspired this artwork. Cyprus, conveniently, is the home of Dimitris Minas, a master ambrotypist who also holds the world Guinness record for the

largest ambrotype ever created. We asked Mina to develop our fictional archive into ambrotypes, which let us simultaneously to reproduce the materiality of the original slide we found and create new "originals." In Figure 5, we can see the lantern slides on two light tables as they were displayed at the Hasselblad Foundation in 2025.

Along with the lantern slides, we created a short 13-minute film that accompanies the slides (see Figure 6). The film follows an archivist at a museum – her name is Martha – who is going through the processes of cataloguing, preserving, identifying, and storing this fictional collection of lantern slides. Martha enlists the assistance of an AI Museum Bot to organize and interpret the archival material. However, this occasionally leads to conflicting information and unexpected glitches. There is a tension between the information provided by the Museum Bot and what the archivist knows and understands. The video has a split screen. On the left, we see the actions of the archivist, and on the right, the workings of the AI bot. The voice over is the conversation between Martha and the Museum Bot.



Figure 5. View from the group exhibition “Bugs and Metamorphosis: Glitching Photography” at the Hasselblad Foundation, Gothenburg, Sweden (7 February – 4 May 2025). Curated by Louise Wolthers and Nina Mangalanayagam. Photograph by Cecilia Sandblom, Hasselblad Foundation.



Figure 6. Film still: “The Archive of Grigoris Antoniou: notes of an archivist” (2024), video, 13:20 min. The artwork includes AI-generated images. © Theopisti Stylianou-Lambert and Alexia Achilleos.

In this work, Martha is our archivist who helps us unravel the tensions between archaeological knowledge, photographic records, and AI. She is a fictional character, but her dilemmas are very real. Interestingly, Virginia Woolf, in her book "A Room of One's Own", likewise invented a fictional novelist – Mary – to guide the reader through the challenges female writers were facing at the time, a technique Moa Martinson (1993) also uses in her novel "Women and Appletrees". Using a mixture of fiction and autobiography, Martinson helps us imagine the unwritten work, lives, and stories of women who did not have the tools to do so themselves. Fictional narratives can serve as a powerful tool for illuminating undocumented experiences when official historical records fall short.

Conclusions

To conclude, photographic archives are by nature fragmented and contain omissions and misrepresentations, but at the same time present us with opportunities to reframe the past and point our conceptual flashlight elsewhere. While archaeological workers were absent from publications of the time, we can find them in photographic archives. They are underrepresented and mute, but they are there. All three projects presented here use arts-based research to bring to the surface the stories of local workers who played a key role in Cypriot archaeology but were omitted from dominant archaeological narratives. They also reflect on how colonial-era legacies and power imbalances continue to be entangled in present-day technological tools. Finally, they critically examine the archival practices of collecting institutions and the complex intersections between colonial photographic records and AI.

To avoid any misunderstandings, it is important to mention that we do not claim that with our alternative and fictional archives we actually fill in archival gaps. That would be impossible and highly problematic on many levels. Instead, we use fictional and alternative archives to raise awareness about the shadows, ghosts,

and hands of archaeology and to attempt to *reframe the colonial framings of the past.*

I have argued here that the photographic production at the turn of the 20th century related to Cypriot archaeology was influenced by the discipline of archaeology, the standpoint of the mainly male, Western archaeologists, and colonial viewpoints and understandings. Simply put, it was the product of its time. But it would be foolish not to also point out that my own work is similarly a product of its time, influenced by current photographic theory, museum studies, postcolonial theories, and critical theory of technology. In other words, my own standpoint as an artist/researcher, using today's technological tools. And as theories and disciplines evolve and change and cast a critical eye on the past, a hundred years from today my own standpoint might also become irrelevant and in need of reframing. And *that* would be OK.

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